

01 OVERVIEW

Brand Engine

Building an AI-driven brand asset system for structured, scalable, on-brand marketing production.

A brand system isn't a style guide people consult. It's a set of rules a machine can follow without you in the room.

CUSTOMER

ROLE

SCOPE

TOOLS

Growfin

AI Systems & Brand Design

Templates, Character, Cover Library

Claude - ChatGPT - Gemini

02 CONTEXT

One small team, an endless stream of assets to ship.

THE BRIEF

Growfin's small marketing team needed to keep pace with a constant stream of campaign assets: webinar promotions, blog covers, social posts, and brand character work, all without budget for more design headcount. The team needed a system that could produce on-brand output reliably, in a fraction of the usual time.

THE CHALLENGE

Each asset type fails differently. A mascot can go off-model in a single generation. A webinar post looks inconsistent the moment the copy length changes. A blog cover loses its identity once the concept gets abstract. A one-off prompt might solve one of these problems, but not all three at once, and not repeatably.

The system had to hold up across all three asset types without being rebuilt every time a new piece was needed.

03 APPROACH

A structured prompt system, not a habit of one-off generation.

The Brand Engine works across three layers of complexity, each engineered to hold its own line of consistency.

01 Marketing Templates

Built using Claude, chosen for its stronger handling of layout and structure in social and marketing formats. Fixed fields (Tag, Heading, Date, CTA, Speaker details) map directly to a consistent visual layout, so changing the input data changes the asset, not the design logic.

02 Brand Character System

A master prompt defines exact anatomy, material finish, color palette, and personality for the 3D brand mascot, paired with a negative prompt listing hard constraints that rule out anything that could break the character's consistency.

03 Cover Library System

Rules and Gemini were given a growing, standing brief on Growfin's visual style, palette, lighting, and illustration logic, so the model retained the design rules across sessions instead of starting cold, while building up an understanding of the AR (accounts receivable) space the covers were illustrating.

The negative prompt discipline is what separates this from casual AI use: rules like no human hands, no costume changes, no altered proportions, no drift toward "scary" or "childish" all exist because they were failure modes encountered first and engineered out after.

04 SYSTEM 01

Webinar Asset Template

Structured input, consistent output, built on Claude for precise layout control. Fixed fields (tag, heading, date, CTA, and speaker details) flow directly into the same visual layout every time, so the design holds steady no matter how the copy changes.

AI PROMPT INPUT - AI OUTPUT, TWO WEBINAR POST VARIANTS

AI Prompt Enabled

Tag: Webinar Post - Square Size - White & Blue

Heading: Heading Paragraph Here

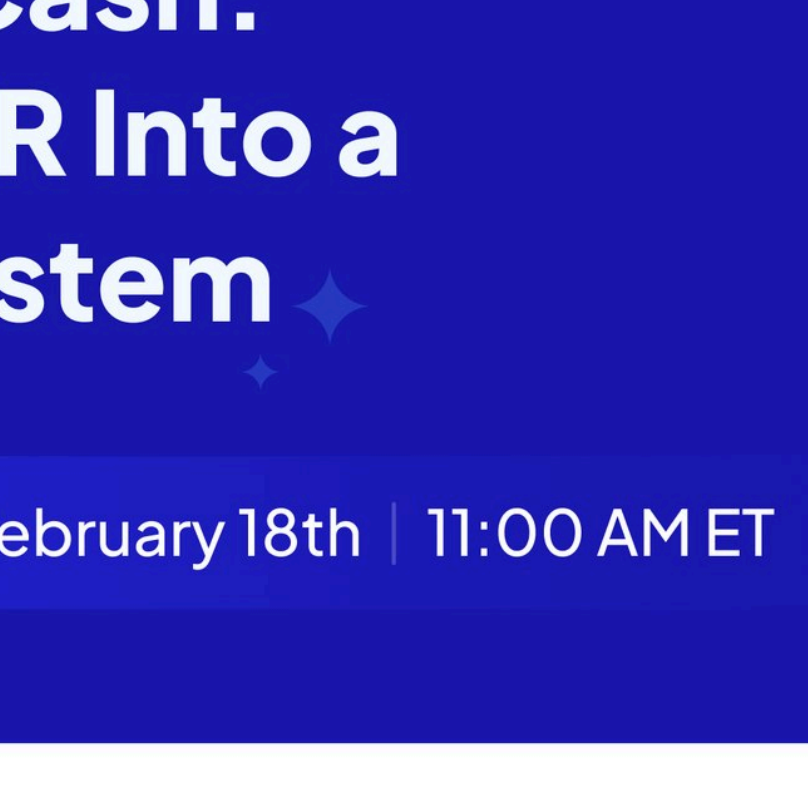
Date: Month Date Time: 08:00 AM ET

CTA: Register Now

Speaker 1: Name: Patrick Bose
Role: Senior AR Manager Company: Companame

Speaker 2: Name: Pradyut Hande Role: Head of Product Marketing Company: Growfin

AI Output



AI Prompt Enabled

Tag: Webinar Post - Square Size - White & Blue

Heading: Heading Paragraph Here

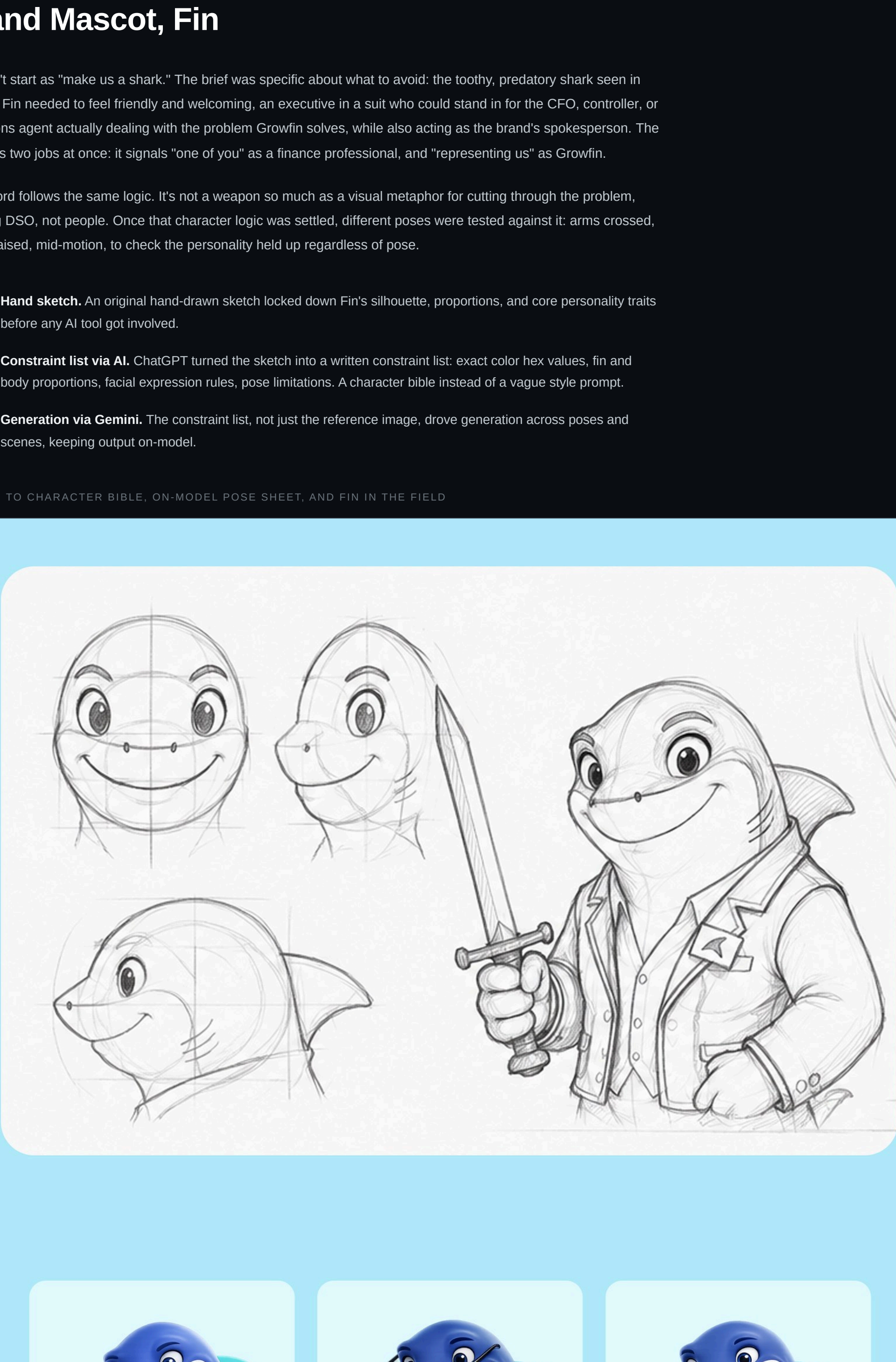
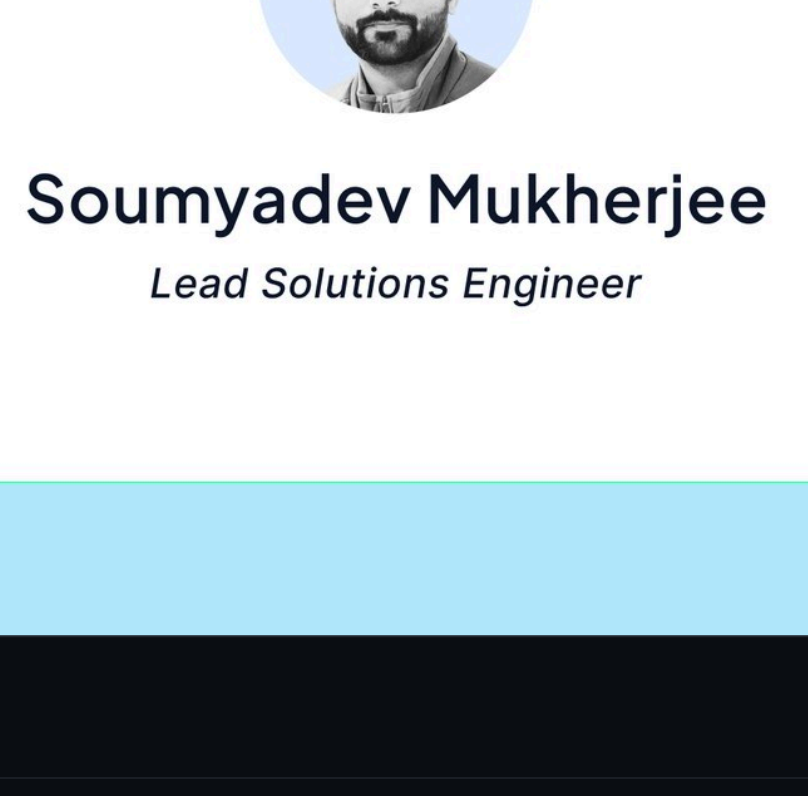
Date: Month Date Time: 12:00 PM ET

CTA: Register Now

Speaker 1: Name: Priya Nair
Role: VP of Finance, CloudScale Inc.

Speaker 2: Name: Daniel Cho
Role: Head of Revenue Ops, Growfin

AI Output



05 SYSTEM 02

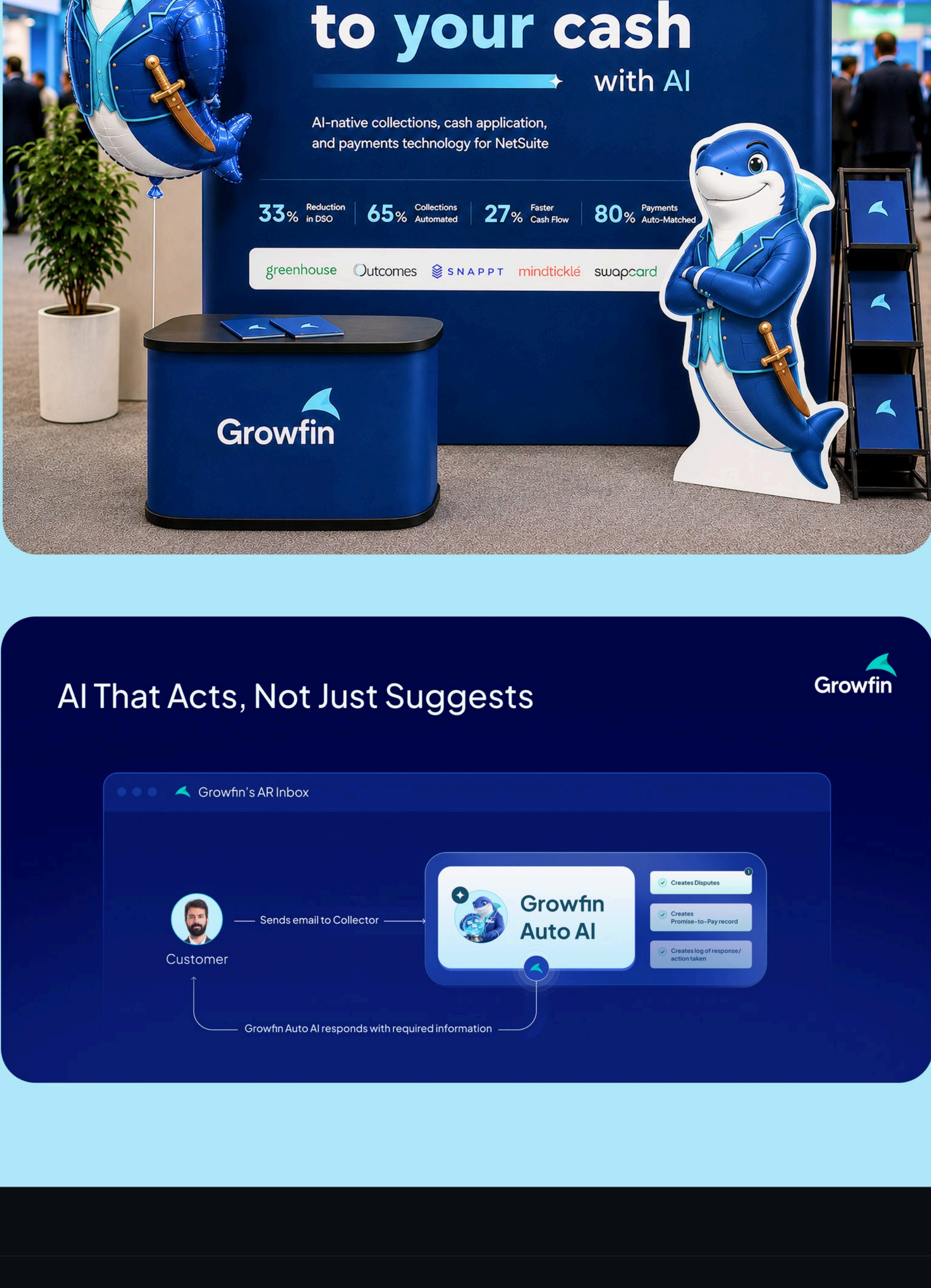
Brand Mascot, Fin

Fin didn't start as "make us a shark." The brief was specific about what to avoid: the toothy, predatory shark seen in movies. Fin needed to feel friendly and welcoming, an executive in a suit who could stand in for the CFO, controller, or collections agent actually dealing with the problem Growfin solves, while also acting as the brand's spokesperson. The suit does two jobs at once: it signals "one of you" as a finance professional, and "representing us" as Growfin.

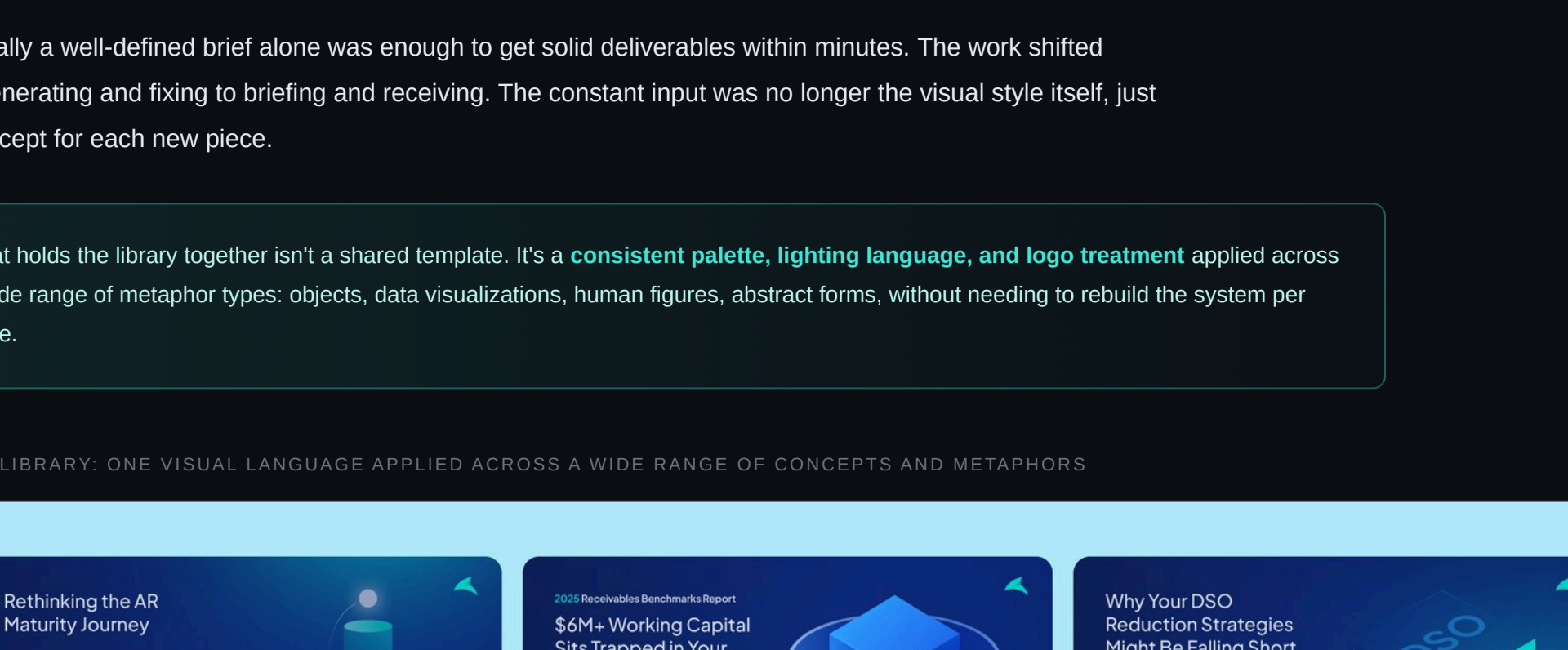
The sword follows the same logic. It's not a weapon so much as a visual metaphor for cutting through the problem, slashing DSO, not people. Once that character logic was settled, different poses were tested against it: arms crossed, sword raised, mid-motion, to check the personality held up regardless of pose.

- Hand sketch.** An original hand-drawn sketch locked down Fin's silhouette, proportions, and core personality traits before any AI tool got involved.
- Constraint list via AI.** ChatGPT turned the sketch into a written constraint list: exact color hex values, fin and body proportions, facial expression rules, pose limitations. A character bible instead of a vague style prompt.
- Generation via Gemini.** The constraint list, not just the reference image, drove generation across poses and scenes, keeping output on-model.

SKETCH TO CHARACTER BIBLE, ON-MODEL POSE SHEET, AND FIN IN THE FIELD



AI That Acts, Not Just Suggests



06 AT SCALE

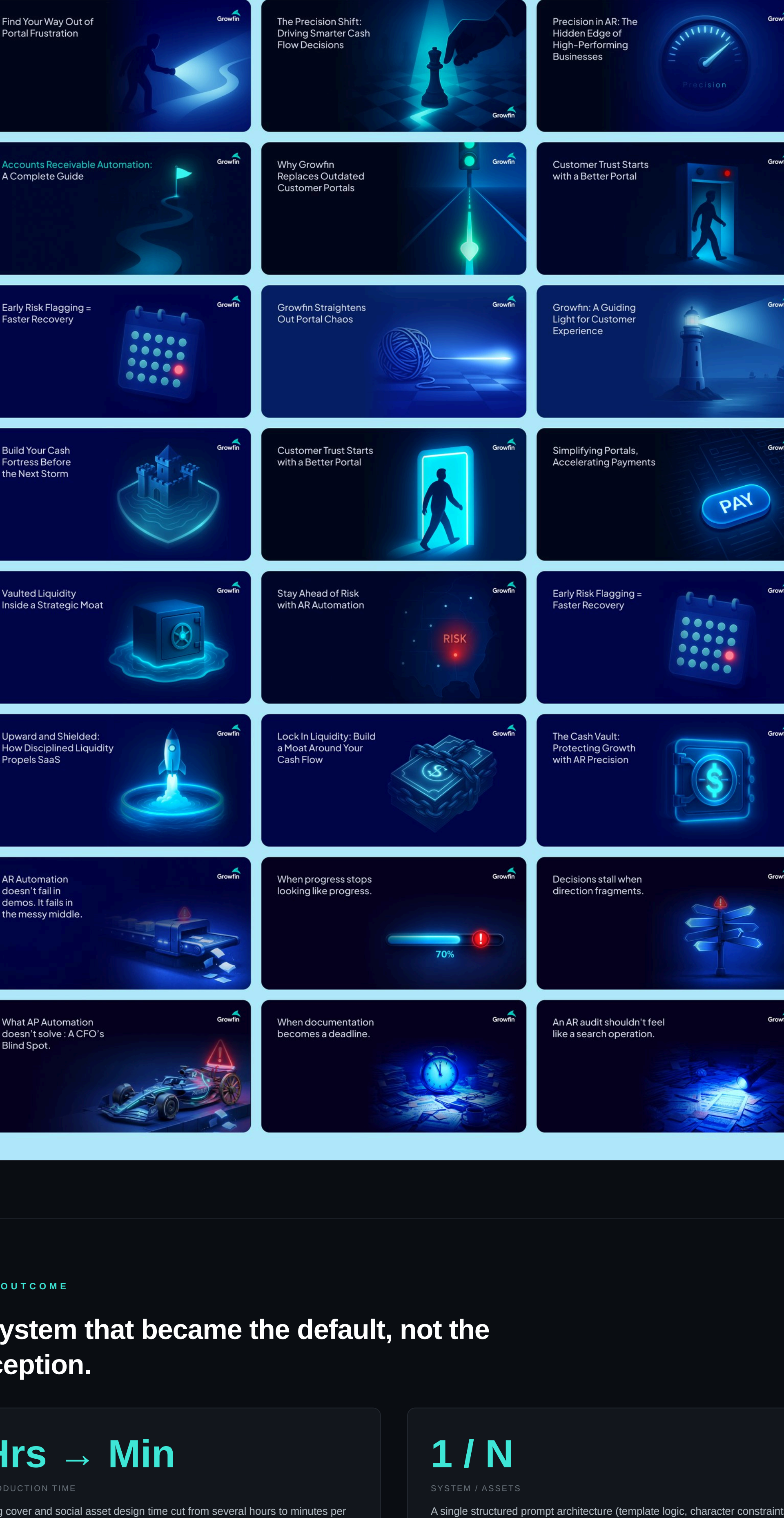
One identity, an entire cover library.

The same discipline carried over to Growfin's full blog and social cover library. Instead of re-briefing the model from scratch each time, GPT and Gemini were fed a standing, evolving reference covering visual style, layout logic, and illustration language. Over time it built up an understanding of both how Growfin looks and what Growfin's product space (AR, receivables, cash flow) actually means.

Eventually a well-defined brief alone was enough to get solid deliverables within minutes. The work shifted from generating and fixing to briefing and receiving. The constant input was no longer the visual style itself, just the concept for each new piece.

What holds the library together isn't a shared template. It's a consistent palette, lighting language, and logo treatment applied across a wide range of metaphor types: objects, data visualizations, human figures, abstract forms, without needing to rebuild the system per piece.

COVER LIBRARY: ONE VISUAL LANGUAGE APPLIED ACROSS A WIDE RANGE OF CONCEPTS AND METAPHORS



07 OUTCOME

A system that became the default, not the exception.

Hrs → Min

PRODUCTION TIME

Blog cover and social asset design time cut from several hours to minutes per piece.

1 / N

SYSTEM ASSETS

A single structured prompt architecture (template logic, character constraints, and standing style memory) reused across webinar campaigns, blog content, and brand character work instead of rebuilt per request.

The system became the default production method for the marketing team's day-to-day content, freeing up design time for higher-leverage creative work instead of repetitive template production.

08 REFLECTION

WHY THIS PROJECT

This is the clearest proof of a broader shift in how I work: treating AI not as a shortcut for a single image, but as a system built with structure, constraints, and failure modes worked out in advance. It's the same discipline behind every other case study here, applied at the level of daily production instead of a single campaign or concept.